Key Messages

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- Average to above-average *Postrera* harvests are anticipated in November/December. No negative shocks are expected to affect labor demand or staple food prices. As a result, acute food insecurity is likely to remain Minimal (IPC 2.0 Phase 1) through the end of the projection period (March 2013). The lean season will begin normally in May.
- The prevalence of coffee rust is two to three times higher than average. This is unlikely to significantly affect the current harvest, but treatment is needed to protect future harvests. Coffee prices are estimated to be high enough to cover this additional production cost, which will favor above-average labor demand between now and March/April.

ZONE	CURRENT ANOMALIES	PROJECTED ANOMALIES
Livelihood Zone 2: Coffee, Agro-industry, and unskilled labor	• Coffee rust prevalence is two to three times higher than average.	• Above-average labor demand in these areas between January and March due to treatment for coffee rust.

Projected Outlook through March 2013

The *Postrera* season, which is harvested in November/December, produces 80 percent of the annual, national red bean production. Rainfall during the *Postrera* season was generally average with a normal cessation in late October. Rainfall was 10 – 20 percent below-average in central areas of the country, but with fair distribution over time. In general, both rainfall performance and crop development have been better than anticipated by pre-season forecasts. In addition, unusually high input support from the government this season—particularly in areas of the East affected by below-average *Primera* rainfall—resulted in a 20-percent increase in planted area